Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion at Penn State Health

An Overview of the Office for Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion

Objectives



- To provide a broad overview of what ODEI does for the health system
- To highlight what we do to support our colleagues and patients

What We Do To Support Our Workforce

DEI Related Policies

- PSH ADM 120
  - Addressing Patient Bias Towards Healthcare Workers
- PSH HR 86
  - Complaints of Unlawful Discrimination or Harassment
- PSH HR 38
  - Personal Behavior and Communications Standards



2025/2026 DEI Programs



- Inclusion Academy
  - Culturally Responsive Care
  - Experiential Learning
- Inclusion Week
- Upstander Café – Bias education and Social Justice series'
- Bilingual Education
- Language Access
- On-Demand Series
- Health Equity Series

And much more!

PENN STATE HEALTH

INCLUSION ACADEMY

Culturally Responsive Care

- Expert-led “working” sessions focused on culturally sensitive services

IA-CRC Series Objectives:

- increase the understanding of cultural norms and expectations of specific populations.
- Helps participants develop the skills and abilities to provide culturally responsive care.
- Increase clinical knowledge and practices that improve health outcomes for diverse patients.

On-Demand Tailored Educational Series

- Tailored educational sessions offered to support PSH values and DEI principles

IA-On-Demand Session Objectives:

- To educate on relevant culturally diverse topics to create a more respectful, inclusive, and culturally responsive patient and staff healthcare environment.

PENN STATE HEALTH

INCLUSION ACADEMY

Inclusive Healthcare: Connecting with Diverse Patients TED-Talk style education

- Online education addressing Culturally Responsive Care for Diverse Patients - Short online (TED-Talk Style) videos

IA-Inclusive Healthcare Learning Objectives:

- Identify the patient culture and practices in addressing particular healthcare considerations for diverse patients
- Recognize actionable culturally responsive care steps to better serve diverse patients.

Experiential Learning: Interactive Sessions for Excellent Patient Care and a Respectful Inclusive Workplace

- Interactive sessions using experiential learning and TED-Talk lessons to better serve diverse populations

Experiential Learning Session Objectives:

- Experiential learning with deep interactive discussions addressing the implication of diverse cultures, faiths, and creeds in offering culturally responsive care for diverse patients.

Upstander Cafés 2025-2026

The First Friday of Each Month

Virtual Upstander Café

Microaggressions & Unconscious Bias Education (MUBE).

- Monthly one-hour sessions
- An opportunity for employees to practice their Upstander Skills by discussing **Microaggressions and Unconscious Bias**
- 07:00 AM to 08:00 AM via Microsoft Teams

Virtual Upstander Café

Social Justice Sessions

- Monthly one-hour sessions
- An opportunity for employees to practice their Upstander Skills by discussing **Social Justice Issues**
- 12:00 PM to 01:00 PM on-site and via Microsoft Teams

Bilingual Education 2025-2026

Bilingual Education Opportunities

- Spanish, Arabic, and sign language for PSH employees willing to enhance their linguistic abilities.

Enhance Proficient Interpreters Pool

- Inventory on bilingual, fluent, and proficient employees
- Opportunities to advance employees fluency bilingual education and improve the pool of potential qualified medical interpreters

Engaging Our Workforce
Business Employee Resource Groups (BERGs)

- Advance the health system's diversity & inclusion goals through creating positive workplace culture for employees with different backgrounds
- Provide foundation for diverse employee population to succeed and contribute to the health system's mission and organizational goals
- Interact with leadership at the entity & system level to implement initiatives to advance needs of the relevant population



Employee Resource Group Categories

BERGs:

- LGBTQ+
- Military/Veteran*
- Multicultural
- Disability
- Interfaith
- Next Gen

*Military/Veteran inclusive of Lebanon County

Resource Groups:

- Network for Under-Represented Residents & Fellows(NURF)
- Black Physician & Professional Staff Association (BPPSA)
- Hispanic Professional Association (HPA)
- Asian Physician & Professional Staff Association (APPA)
- International Workforce Inclusion (IWI)



What We Do To Support Our Patients

Patient Advisory Councils

Diversity Council

- Creating a welcoming, respectful, supportive, and safe environment for all
- Holding the health system accountable for DEI education
- Critical evaluation of PSH practices
- Advise Vice President and Chief Diversity Office on inclusive policies and practices



Disability Inclusion Advisory Council



- Promote positive community relationships
- Improving the quality, safety, and experience of care for patients with disabilities
- Advise Vice President and Chief Diversity Office on inclusive policies and practices

Sexual and Gender Minority Advisory Council

- Guides the implementation of SGM-inclusive practices
- Equitable and inclusive environment for SGM patients
- Advise Vice President and Chief Diversity Office on inclusive polices and practices



Multicultural Advisory Council



- Guides the implementation of multicultural inclusive practices
- Equitable and inclusive environment for multicultural patients
- Advise Vice President and Chief Diversity Office on inclusive polices and practices

Penn State Health – Health Equity Pillars

Community Engagement	Health Equity Research	Data Infrastructure Collection and Access	Culturally Appropriate Patient Care Inpatient & Outpatient	Workforce Diversification and Workplace Climate	Organizational Accountability

Facets for Each Pillar

- Information Technology and Required Data
- Regulatory Requirements: Community, Outpatient, Inpatient
- Communication: Workforce Governance, External Community
- Education
- Funding, Resources and Strategic Planning

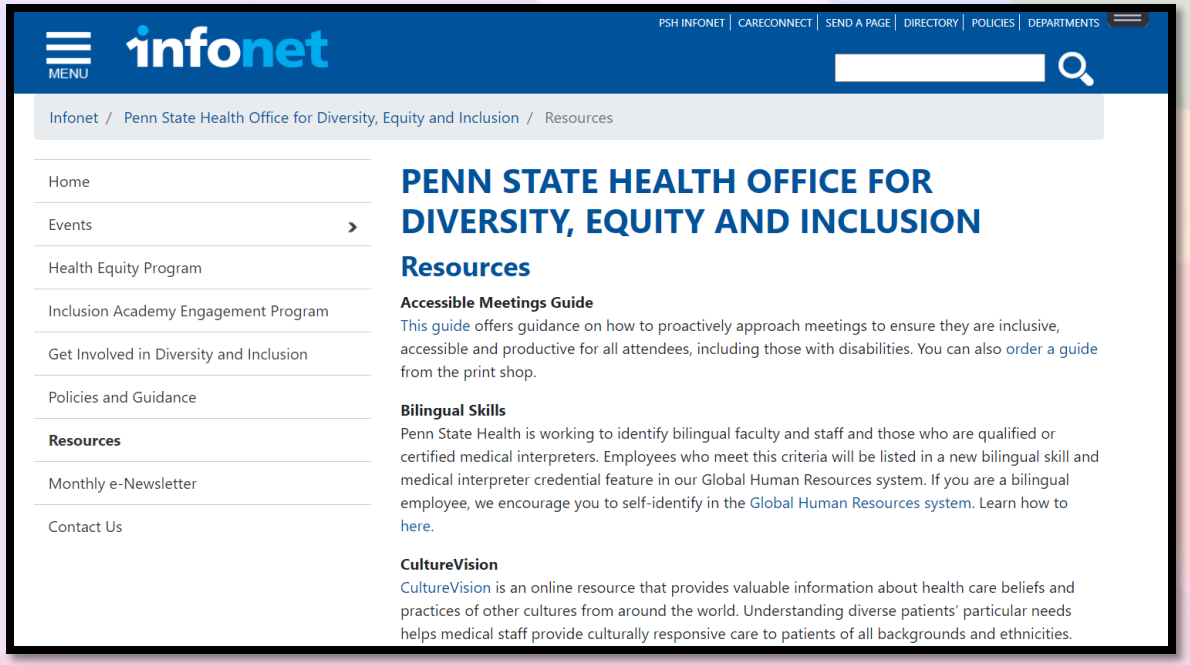
Diversity Resources

Infonet, Printshop, and More

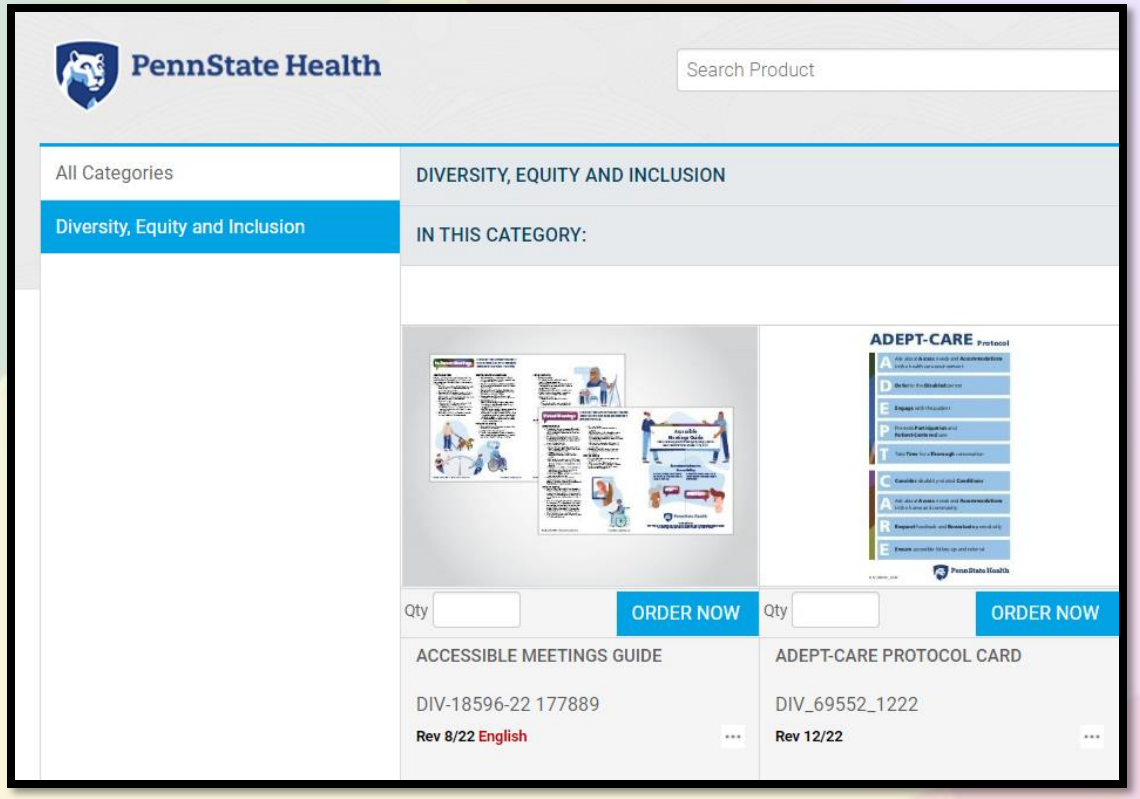


ODEI infonet Page

- DEI events
- Inclusion Academy Information
- Resources
- Policies and Guidance
- Health Equity Program
- Ways to Become Involved
- Contact Information



Diversity Resources Available in the Printshop



- Virtual Backgrounds
- Bias/Microaggression Cards
- Accessibility Brochures
- Pronoun Posters
- Guidelines for Native and Non-Native Speakers
- ADEPT-CARE Cards
- Flyers
- Posters

Diversity Resources
DEI Concerns

PSH Compliance Hotline

- (800) 560-1637
- Americans with Disabilities Act
- Bias and Micro-Aggressions
- Discrimination
- Retaliation



Office for Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion

- diversity@pennstatehealth.psu.edu
- (717) 531-1012



Thank you

If you have any questions or suggestions, contact the Penn State Health Office for Diversity, Equity and Inclusion at diversity@pennstatehealth.psu.edu or (717) 531-1012.